Jesus Christ, the Son of God the Father

Melvin J. Ballard

Deseret News, 23 Dec 1923;
Sermons & Missionary Services of Melvin J. Ballard, pg 166-167;
Melvin J. Ballard, Crusader for Righteousness, pg 144.

One of the great questions that I have referred to that the world is concerned about, and is in confusion over, is as to whether or not His was a virgin birth, a birth wherein divine power interceded. Joseph Smith made it perfectly clear that Jesus Christ told the absolute truth, as did those who testify concerning Him, the Apostles of the Lord Jesus Christ, wherein He is declared to be the very Son of God. And if God the Father is not the real Father of Jesus Christ, then we are in confusion; then He is not in reality the Son of God. But we declare that He *is* the Only Begotten of the Father **in the flesh.**

Mary told the story most beautifully when she said that an angel of the Lord came to her and told her that she had found favor in the sight of God and had come to be worthy of the fulfillment of the promises theretofore made to become the virgin mother of the Redeemer of the world. Referring to the event, she said: "God hath done wonderful things unto me."

"And the Holy Ghost came upon her," in the story, "and she came into the presence of the highest." No man or woman can live in mortality and survive the presence of the Highest except by the sustaining power of the Holy Ghost. So it came upon her to prepare her for admittance into the divine presence, and the power of the Highest, who is the Father, was present, and overshadowed her, and the holy Child that was born of her was called the Son of God.

Men who deny this, or who think that it degrades our Father, have no true conception of the sacredness of the most marvelous power with which God has endowed mortal men—the power of creation. Even though that power may be used and may become a mere harp of pleasure to the wicked, nevertheless it is the most sacred and holy and divine function with which God has endowed man. Made holy, it is retained by the Father of us all, and in His exercise of that great and marvelous creative power and function He did not debase Himself, degrade Himself, nor debauch His daughter. Thus Christ became the literal Son of a divine Father, and no one else was worthy to be His father.